Postgraduate Research:
A Step-by-Step Approach

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Link to the sources

All the presentation will be available via the following QR code.

This presentations and related files will be available on my GitHub page (right) a Telegram Channel (left) that is accessible via the following QR code (Scan/Click on the QR code).

A Training-by-Doing Approach

This is the main approach in these lecture series

Getting Going

The initial steps in a postgraduate research

In one word, how would you describe your studies until this point?

1) Really great
2) Great
3) Very good
4) Good
5) OK
6) So-so
7) Meh
8) Bad
9) Very bad
10) Couldn’t be worse

What is the purpose of postgraduate studies?

- Older purpose and function:
  - ✓ **A thesis/report which contains some original material**
- Current purpose and function:
  - ✓ **A *programme* of study** in which the student learns a **wide variety of skills** not only necessary for them **to do the research**, but also useful **in any kind of employment** they may take up after their research degree

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What is the training provided to research students?

Generate a piece of research work ⇔ Skills required to produce that research work

- It enables you, as a research student, under the guidance of your supervisors, to acquire a set of required skills as you proceed through your Master's or PhD programme that fall into the following sections:
  - ✓ Research skills and techniques;
  - ✓ Research environment;
  - ✓ Research management;
  - ✓ Personal effectiveness;
  - ✓ Communication skills;
  - ✓ Networking and teamworking;
  - ✓ Career development.

Finding Your Feet

Why Am I Here and Doing This?

Activity #1:

Please write a maximum of **100 words** on:

- **Why would you like to do a research degree?** Try to be as specific as possible.
- **What you expect to have come out of your work** when you have finished in terms of:
  - results
  - you personally
  - what you will be able to do that you could not do before.

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What are the essential reasons for doing a research degree?

Activity #2

- Make a list of what you consider to be ‘essential’ and ‘supporting’ reasons for someone undertaking a research degree or dissertation topic.

- **Essential reasons** might include:
  - Personal development.
  - To be able to make a difference – for example, a desire to change practice in work or to learn more about a ‘condition’ that a student or members of their family have experienced.
  - To follow a new or better career.
  - Burning interest in a topic (intellectual curiosity).
  - To keep one’s mind active.
- **Supporting reasons** might include:
  - Current job is a dead end.
  - For the experience.
  - Employer sponsorship is available.

Why Am I Here and Doing This?

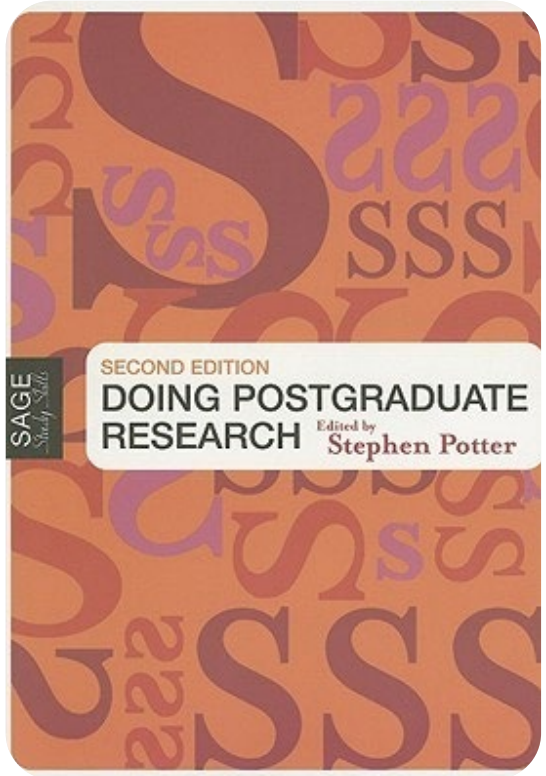
Homework #1

- Return to what you wrote down in Activity #1.
- How do your own reasons relate to your categories of essential and supporting reasons for doing a research degree?

References

Included but not limited to…

References: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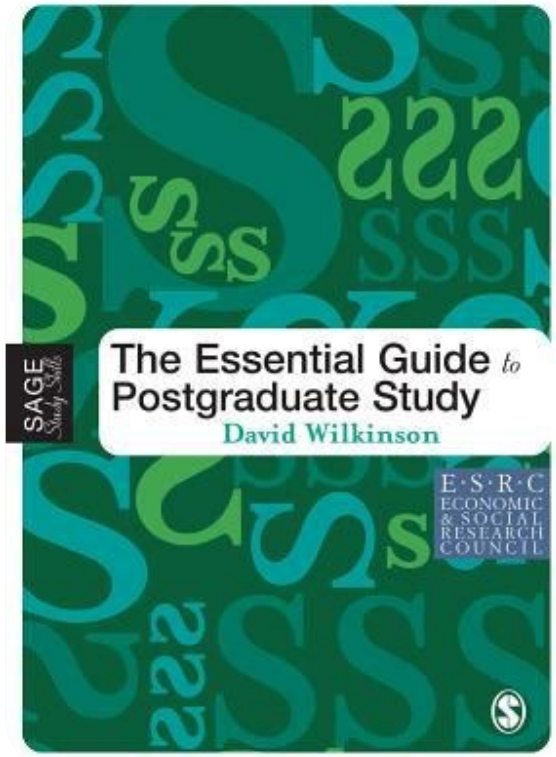
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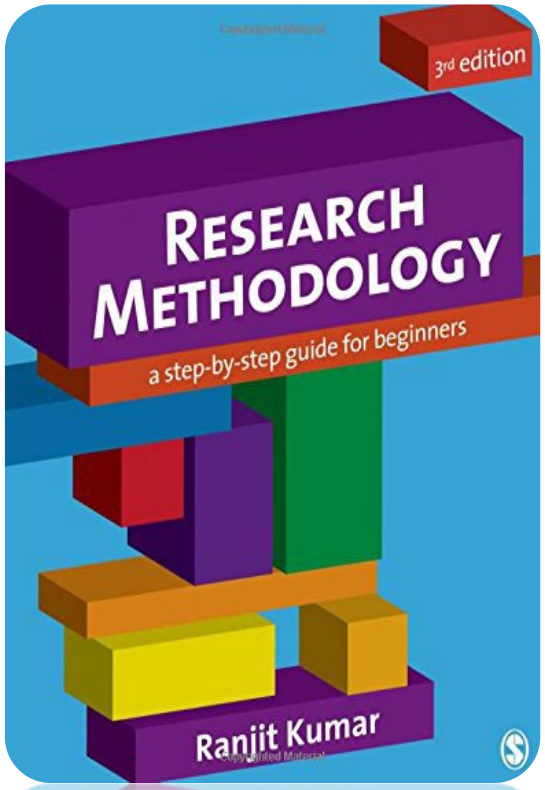
3rd edition
RESEARCH METHODOLOGY
a step-by-step guide for beginners
Ranjit Kumar

Summary

Why Am I Here and Doing This?

It is important to ask yourself this question regularly and plan for the best outcome, accordingly.

Thank you

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